

Congregation Bible Study — Week of June 29 – July 5, 2026

Learn From the Bible (lfb) — Lessons 98 & 99

8 comment options + 2 research/insight angles (highlighted in blue). Each ~25–30 sec spoken (≈ 65–75 words). Each focuses on *what we learn about Jehovah/Jesus* and *how to use it in our ministry*. Anchored to verses actually referenced in the lesson.

#	Lesson	Verse anchor	What I take away
98-1	Christianity Spreads	Acts 13:2	The holy spirit is what sends us — we don't send ourselves
98-2	Christianity Spreads	Acts 14:15	Point past yourself. Always.
98-3	Christianity Spreads	Acts 14:22	Real love doesn't make false promises about the road ahead
98-4	Christianity Spreads	Acts 18:3	Honest labor and honest ministry can honor Jehovah together
98-R	Christianity Spreads	Acts 19:9	Research <i>Insight book:</i> Paul used his siesta hours to preach daily for two years
99-1	A Jailer Learns	Acts 16:25	Joy in Jehovah doesn't depend on our circumstances
99-2	A Jailer Learns	Acts 16:28	Ministering to a stranger starts with noticing them
99-3	A Jailer Learns	Acts 16:30, 31	Meet the honest question with a clear answer
99-4	A Jailer Learns	Acts 16:33	When truth reaches an honest heart, action follows the same night
99-R	A Jailer Learns	Acts 16:37	Research <i>Insight book:</i> Paul used his Roman citizenship to protect the congregation

Lesson 98 — Christianity Spreads to Many Nations

Comment 98-1 — The spirit sent them

*"Of all persons **set aside** for me Barnabas and Saul for the work to which I have called them."* — Acts 13:2

Comment (~29 sec):

What struck me in Acts 13:2 is who did the sending. The apostles didn't nominate Paul and Barnabas — the *holy spirit* did. It tells me Jehovah is actively directing the preaching work. He picks. He sends. In our ministry, we're not just filling a schedule. We're being sent by Jehovah's spirit to specific people, in specific territory, at specific times.

Comment 98-2 — "We too are men"

*"**We too are men** with the same infirmities as you..."* — Acts 14:15

Comment (~27 sec):

What I love about Acts 14:15 is how quickly Paul refused worship. The people wanted to make him and Barnabas gods. Paul's response was immediate — *"We too are men with the same infirmities."* No hesitation. It reminds me that no matter how much someone we teach begins to appreciate us, our job is always to point past ourselves — to Jehovah alone.

Comment 98-3 — Through many tribulations

"It is necessary for us to enter into the Kingdom of God through **many tribulations**." — Acts 14:22

Comment (~26 sec):

Acts 14:22 has a phrase every publisher should carry — *"through many tribulations we must enter the Kingdom of God."* Notice, Paul didn't hide this from new disciples. He told them upfront. Real love doesn't make false promises. In the ministry, we do the same. We don't sell an easy life. We point people to a hope worth the road.

Comment 98-4 — Paul at the workbench

"...for by trade they were **tentmakers**." — Acts 18:3

Comment (~28 sec):

Acts 18:3 gives me a picture of Paul I don't always think about — the apostle at a workbench, making tents. He preached full-time, but he also worked with his hands. It tells me Jehovah's work has never required us to choose between honest labor and honest ministry. Both together can honor him. Whatever our day job, the ministry is still the mission.

Research

Comment 98-R — Ephesus, five hours a day, two years

"...he separated the disciples from them, giving talks daily in the school auditorium of **Tyrannus**." — Acts 19:9

Comment (~30 sec):

Here's a historical detail from the *Insight on the Scriptures*. In Ephesus, Paul rented *"the school auditorium of Tyrannus"* and taught there every day. Some manuscripts add that he used it from the fifth hour to the tenth — roughly 11 am to 4 pm — the mid-day hours when Ephesians took their afternoon rest. That means Paul used his siesta to preach. Five hours a day. For two years. What a schedule.

Lesson 99 — A Jailer Learns the Truth

Comment 99-1 — Singing at midnight

"About the middle of the night, Paul and Silas were **praying and praising God with song**..." — Acts 16:25

Comment (~29 sec):

Acts 16:25 always moves me. Paul and Silas had just been beaten and thrown into the deepest part of the prison, feet in stocks. And at midnight — they were *singing*. Not complaining. Not planning revenge. Praising Jehovah. It tells me joy in Jehovah doesn't depend on our circumstances. In the ministry, that's often the loudest witness — how we sound when things go wrong.

Comment 99-2 — "Do not harm yourself"

"**Do not harm yourself**, for we are all here!" — Acts 16:28

Comment (~28 sec):

What gets me about Acts 16:28 is Paul's alertness. The earthquake broke every door open. Paul could have run. Instead, he shouted to the jailer, "*Do not harm yourself, for we are all here!*" He saved the life of the man who had just chained his feet. It reminds me — ministering to a stranger, even one who has been unkind to us, starts with noticing them.

Comment 99-3 — "What must I do to get saved?"

"What must I do to get saved?" — Acts 16:30

Comment (~28 sec):

Acts 16:30 records one of the most direct spiritual questions in Scripture — *"What must I do to get saved?"* And notice — Paul didn't tell the jailer to attend meetings first or read a book. He said, *"Believe in the Lord Jesus."* Simple. Then he stayed and taught him. In the ministry, I want the same instinct. Meet the honest question with a clear answer. Then keep teaching.

Comment 99-4 — Same hour, no delay

"...he took them with him in that hour of the night and washed their wounds; and he and his entire household were baptized without delay." — Acts 16:33

Comment (~28 sec):

Acts 16:33 shows me what real conversion looks like. In the same hour the jailer heard the truth, he washed Paul and Silas's wounds — the wounds *he* had helped inflict — and got baptized with his whole family. No delay. No *"let me think about it for a while."* When Jehovah's truth reaches an honest heart, action follows the same night.

Research

Comment 99-R — Philippi as a Roman colony

"They flogged us publicly, uncondemned, though we are Romans..." — Acts 16:37

Comment (~30 sec):

Here's a historical note. Philippi was a **Roman colony**, meaning its residents had special legal privileges. The *Insight book* explains that Paul later refused to leave the jail quietly — as a Roman citizen, he had been beaten publicly, without trial, which was illegal. Paul used his legal standing not for himself, but to protect the young congregation's future in Philippi. Legal knowledge, used carefully, for Jehovah's work.